HOLY INFANT JESUS PARISH
MUSIC MINISTRY COMMUNITY
San Fernando, Masbate

CONSTITUTION, BY-LAWS, AND CODE OF CONDUCT HANDBOOK

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PREAMBLE

We, the members of the Holy Infant Jesus Parish Music Ministry Community, united in faith and service, establish this Constitution and By-Laws to guide our mission of glorifying God through music, fostering harmony within our group, and upholding the values of the Catholic Church.

ARTICLE I – NAME AND NATURE

Section 1. The organization shall be known as the *Holy Infant Jesus Parish Music Ministry Community* (hereinafter referred to as the HIJP MMC).

Section 2. The Ministry is a service group of the Parish Commission on Worship under the direct supervision of the Parish Priest and the appointed members of the MMC Council.

Section 3. The Ministry exists not as a performance group, but as a liturgical servant of the Catholic Church, with the primary purpose of leading the faithful in sung prayer during the Sacred Liturgy.

ARTICLE II – MEMBERSHIP

Section 1. Membership is open to baptized Catholics of good moral standing, committed to active participation in parish life and willing to undergo training and formation.

Section 2. Members must attend rehearsals, Masses, and assigned liturgical functions regularly.

Section 3. A probationary period of three (3) months shall be observed for new members, after which the Choir Coordinator and MMC Council will decide on permanent membership.

Section 4. Members must sign and pledge to uphold this Constitution and By-Laws.

ARTICLE III – ORGANIZATIONAL STRUCTURE

Section 1. The Ministry shall be headed by:

1) Spiritual Director (Parish Priest)
2) Music Ministry Council Members
   a. Ministry President
   b. Ministry Vice President
   c. Ministry Director of Music
3) Choir Chairpersons
4) Individual Committee Heads
5) Section Leaders (Soprano, Alto, Tenor, Bass / Instruments as needed)

Section 2. MMC Council Members are chosen by the Parish Pastoral Council while the Ministry Committee Heads are chosen by the MMC Council.

ARTICLE IV – DISCIPLINE DURING PRACTICES AND REHEARSALS

Section 1. Members shall arrive on time for rehearsals. Repeated tardiness (three consecutive times without valid reason) shall merit disciplinary action.

Section 2. Mobile phones must be on silent or off during rehearsals, except in cases of emergency.

Section 3. Talking, joking, or causing distractions during practice is prohibited unless authorized by the Conductor.

Section 4. Members must bring their own songbooks, music sheets, or instruments as required.

Section 5. Respect must always be shown to the Conductor, Section Leaders, and fellow members during rehearsals.

Section 6. Absences must be reported in advance to the Choir Chairperson/Director of Music. Three unexcused absences within a quarter may result in suspension.

ARTICLE V – ATTITUDE AND CONDUCT

Section 1. Members must live as witnesses of the Catholic faith, showing respect, humility, and charity inside and outside the Ministry.

Section 2. Gossip, slander, and divisive behavior are strictly prohibited.

Section 3. Any form of disrespect toward the Parish Priest, Choir Coordinator, or fellow members shall be subject to disciplinary measures.

Section 4. Romantic relationships within the Ministry must not interfere with rehearsals, liturgies, or the unity of the group.

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ARTICLE VI – SOCIAL MEDIA AND PUBLIC REPRESENTATION

Section 1. Members represent the Ministry both online and offline. Conduct on social media must reflect Catholic values.

Section 2. Posting content that ridicules the Church, clergy, parish activities, or fellow members is prohibited.

Section 3. Personal disagreements shall never be aired on social media; issues must be resolved internally through dialogue.

Section 4. Use of the Ministry's name, logo, or photos of official activities must be approved by the Music Ministry Council before being posted publicly.

Section 5. Members are encouraged to use social media as a tool for evangelization, promoting the Ministry positively.

ARTICLE VII – DISCIPLINARY ACTIONS

Section 1. Minor offenses (tardiness, minor disruptions) → Verbal warning → Written warning → Temporary suspension.

Section 2. Major offenses (public scandal, defamation, grave disrespect, repeated absenteeism) → Immediate investigation by the Music Ministry Council → Possible suspension or expulsion, subject to approval of the MMC Council.

Section 3. Members who are disciplined have the right to a dialogue and explanation before sanctions are enforced.

ARTICLE VIII – BY-LAWS

1. **Attendance**: All members must attend at least 75% of all practices and liturgical assignments per quarter.

2. **Uniform**: Members must wear the prescribed attire during Mass and events; improper attire may bar participation.

3. **Alcohol/Drugs**: Members under the influence of alcohol or drugs shall not be allowed to sing/serve and may face suspension.

4. **Financial Contribution**: Voluntary contributions for uniforms, songbooks, or events may be collected transparently by the Treasurer.

5. **Respect for Liturgy**: Sacred silence and prayerful disposition must be maintained before, during, and after Mass.

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ARTICLE IX – AMENDMENTS

This Constitution and By-Laws may be amended by a two-thirds (2/3) vote of active members, with the approval of the MMC Council

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ARTICLE X – EFFECTIVITY

This Constitution and By-Laws shall take effect immediately upon approval by the members of the Ministry Council and confirmation by the Parish Priest.

CODE OF DISCIPLINE & MEMBER HANDBOOK

of the

Holy Infant Jesus Parish Music Ministry Community

PART I – INTRODUCTION

This Code of Discipline serves as the **guidebook** for all members of the HIJP-MMC. It supplements the Constitution and By-Laws, providing specific rules of conduct and discipline. Every member is required to **read, understand, and sign** this handbook as a pledge of commitment to serve the Lord faithfully through music.

PART II – GENERAL EXPECTATIONS

1. **Prayerfulness**: Every rehearsal and liturgical service begins and ends with prayer.

2. **Respect**: All members must treat each other with dignity and charity.

3. **Commitment**: Choir membership is a ministry, not a hobby; punctuality, discipline, and dedication are expected.

4. **Witness**: Members represent Christ and the Church inside and outside the choir.

PART III – DISCIPLINE DURING PRACTICE & REHEARSALS

1. **Punctuality** – Arrive at least **15 minutes before** practice or liturgy. Latecomers must enter quietly without disturbing others.

2. **Preparedness** – Bring songbooks, sheet music, and required instruments. Members without materials may be asked to observe rather than participate.

3. **Focus** – Refrain from unnecessary talking, eating, or phone use during rehearsals.

4. **Respect for Leaders** – Follow instructions of the Conductor, Section Leaders, or Coordinator without argument during sessions.

5. **Attendance** – Missing **three unexcused practices or services** within a quarter may result in suspension.

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PART IV – CONDUCT INSIDE AND OUTSIDE THE MINISTRY

1. **Inside the Ministry**
    - Avoid gossip, cliques, or divisive behavior.
    - Conflicts must be brought to the Council for mediation.
    - Maintain a spirit of humility and service at all times.

2. **Outside the Ministry**
    - Members are expected to live a life consistent with Catholic morals.
    - Public misconduct (drunkenness, scandalous relationships, fighting, etc.) that brings shame to the Church may lead to expulsion.

- Romantic relationships within the choir must never disrupt unity or focus on ministry.

PART V – SOCIAL MEDIA POLICY

1. Members must not post **offensive, vulgar, or defamatory content** against the Church, Parish, clergy, or fellow members.

2. Internal conflicts must not be aired publicly online.

3. Posting pictures/videos of choir activities must first be approved by the Council.

4. Members are encouraged to use social media as a platform for **evangelization, inspiration, and positivity**.

PART VI – DISCIPLINARY ACTIONS

1. **Minor Offenses** (tardiness, unnecessary talking, forgetting materials, etc.)
    - 1st Offense: Verbal warning
    - 2nd Offense: Written warning
    - 3rd Offense: One-week suspension

2. **Major Offenses** (disrespect to leaders, public misconduct, repeated absenteeism, social media violations, immoral behavior, intoxication before Mass, etc.)
    - 1st Offense: Written warning + dialogue with the Council and Parish Priest.
    - 2nd Offense: Suspension (1–3 months)
    - 3rd Offense: Expulsion from the Ministry

3. Members under disciplinary action may request a **dialogue and appeal** before the Council.

PART VII – MEMBER COMMITMENTS

By signing this document, I pledge to:

1. Serve God and the Church faithfully through this Ministry.
2. Attend rehearsals and liturgies regularly and on time.
3. Respect my leaders, co-members, and the sacred nature of our service.
4. Avoid scandalous behavior in person and on social media.
5. Accept the discipline of the Ministry with humility.

PART VIII – ACKNOWLEDGEMENT FORM

I,_____,
a member of the Holy Infant Jesus Parish Music Ministry Community, hereby acknowledge that I have **read, understood, and agreed** to the Constitution, By-Laws, and this Code of Discipline Handbook. I pledge to follow its rules and accept the consequences of any violations.

Signature:_____
Date: _____